

BM3 — Lesson 4: Joseph of Arimathea

Trust the Process



Theme: Faith & Foresight



Background Text : Matthew 27:57–61; John 19:38–42



Key Verse: John 19:38 (WEB)

“After these things, Joseph of Arimathea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews, asked of Pilate that he might take away Jesus’ body. Pilate gave him permission. He came therefore and took away his body.”

 *Faith that honors Jesus even when the story looks finished.*



Appetizer – Faith in Action, John 19:38a; Matt 27:57–58

³⁸ After these things, Joseph of Arimathaea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews,

⁵⁷ When the even was come, there came a rich man of Arimathaea, named Joseph, who also himself was Jesus' disciple: ⁵⁸ He went to Pilate, and begged the body of Jesus. Then Pilate commanded the body to be delivered

Joseph of Arimathea was a rich man, a respected council member, and a quiet follower of Jesus. When many had run away in fear, he stepped forward in love and courage. He went straight to Pilate and asked for the body of the crucified Christ—a bold, risky request that publicly tied his name to Jesus at the very moment things looked the worst.

Even in loss, faith moves us to act in honor. Joseph’s decision to claim Jesus’ body was not loud or flashy, but it was a quiet and powerful display of devotion when many others had fled.



Reflection Question

When have you had to act on your faith quietly but boldly, even when others were afraid to stand?

Main Course – The Pivot

Bite 1 Provision in Place, Matt 27:59–60

⁵⁹Joseph took the body and wrapped it in a clean linen cloth ⁶⁰and laid it in his own new tomb, which he had cut out in the rock. Then he rolled a large stone against the door of the tomb, and departed.

Joseph used what he had already prepared for himself—a new tomb carved in the rock—to honor Jesus. He wrapped the Lord’s body carefully, placed Him in that tomb, and sealed it with a great stone. What Joseph once thought was for his future became part of God’s bigger plan.

God’s provision is never late. Long before Jesus’ crucifixion, the Father had already chosen and prepared Joseph to meet this moment. What looked like a personal investment (a private tomb) became a kingdom assignment.

Author’s Commentary

It wasn’t just a believer who requested the body of Jesus, but Joseph of Arimathea—a wealthy man and quiet follower of Christ. He didn’t realize that the tomb he built for himself would one day hold the body of the Savior of the world. His influence and position on the council gave him access to Pilate, and because of that, the king granted his request for the body. God had already provided everything needed from Christ’s birth to His burial. All we must do is trust the process.

Sometimes the Lord will place you in a role, job, or position you don’t fully understand—not for your comfort, but for His assignment.

Reflection Question

Is there something God has called you to do that you don’t yet understand? Are you willing to trust the process while your faith grows?

Bite 2 – Courage to Be Counted, John 19:38–39

³⁸After these things, Joseph of Arimathea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews, asked of Pilate that he might take away Jesus’ body. Pilate gave him permission. He came therefore and took away his body. ³⁹Nicodemus, who at first came to Jesus by night, also came bringing a mixture of myrrh and aloes, about a hundred Roman pounds

Joseph had been a *secret* disciple, afraid of what the Jewish leaders might say. But at the cross, his secret faith became public action. Nicodemus, who once came to Jesus at night, joined him in this bold, costly act of honor. Both men stepped out of the shadows to align themselves with a “condemned” Messiah.

There comes a time when quiet belief must become visible obedience. Faith that stays hidden forever never fully walks in purpose. Joseph and Nicodemus show us that even if you started secretly, God can still call you to stand boldly.

Bite 3 – Faith Sealed in Stone, John 19:40–42

So they took Jesus’ body, and bound it in linen cloths with the spices, as the custom of the Jews is to bury. Now in the place where he was crucified there was a garden. In the garden was a new tomb in which no man had ever yet been laid. Then because of the Jews’ Preparation Day (for the tomb was near at hand) they laid Jesus there.

Everything about this scene looked final: the spices, the linen, the new tomb, the stone. Yet heaven knew this was not the end—it was a setup. The garden tomb was not a permanent resting place; it was the stage for resurrection.

When you trust God’s process, even what looks like a burial can become the birthplace of breakthrough. What we call “the end” may be where God is just getting started.

Author’s Commentary

Sometimes the prompt feels “silly,” but obedience is the key to a chain of events only God can see. While stationed in Guantanamo Bay, Cuba, I felt a sudden urge at the altar to hug and speak life to a sister who was hurting. In my head, it felt random, but I chose to move anyway.

I didn’t know that another woman in the service, Sister Williams, had just challenged God for a sign that He was still listening. She actually had a vision of me hugging that sister before I even stood up. Because I didn’t let my “lack of action” get in the way, a chain reaction happened: the sister at the altar received comfort, and Williams received the divine confirmation she desperately needed. One “silly” step of faith can be the answer to someone else’s secret prayer.

To-Go Box

- Faith and foresight remind us that obedience opens doors long before we know we’ll need to walk through them.
- God often uses our resources, positions, and plans for purposes bigger than we imagined.
- Trust that God’s plans are already in motion—even when you can’t see the full picture yet.
- Like Joseph of Arimathea, your quiet preparation today may be part of a major move of God tomorrow.

Closing Prayer

“Lord, thank You for Joseph of Arimathea’s example of quiet, courageous faith. Help me to trust Your process, even when I don’t understand every step. Use what I have and where I am for Your purpose, not just my plans. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

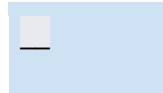
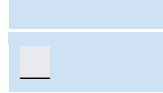
Word Study

- **Arimathea** – A town near Jerusalem; the name is associated with “heights” or a high place.
- **Joseph (Hebrew: *Yosef*)** – “He will add” or “He increases” — prophetic of increase and multiplication.
- **Trust (Hebrew: *Batach*)** – To rely on, be confident, or secure; a firm confidence in God’s provision and timing.

Write a short line about where you need to *batach*—to lean hard into trusting God’s process:

Activity – Connect the Process

Match each act of faith (left) with the result (right).

Match	Activity	Phrase
	1 Joseph’s request for Jesus’ body	A The burial fulfilled prophecy with reverence.
	2 Wrapping Jesus in linen	B A temporary seal that set up resurrection
	3 Building his own tomb	C Jesus’ body was placed in a tomb of honor.
	4 Rolling the stone	D God used a personal plan for divine purpose

Appendix – Breakfast Month 3 (AE) Answer Key

Theme: Faith & Foresight – Youth Edition

Lesson 1 – Rahab: Faith That Took Action

Activity – True or False: Rahab’s Faith

1. Rahab was an Israelite woman raised in a godly home.
➤ False – She was a Canaanite woman from Jericho.
2. The scarlet rope was a sign of the agreement between Rahab and the spies.
➤ True
3. Rahab’s actions showed both faith in God and concern for her family.
➤ True
4. Rahab’s faith only affected her, not anyone else.
➤ False – Her whole household was saved.
5. Rahab is later mentioned in the family line of Jesus.
➤ True – She appears in His genealogy.

Lesson 2 – Abigail: Wisdom on the Move

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Abigail acted with **wisdom** and faith, not fear.
 2. Nabal’s pride led to his **death**.
 3. David praised God for Abigail’s **good sense/wisdom**.
 4. Abigail’s wisdom prevented **bloodshed/killing** and brought peace.
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Lesson 3 – The Centurion: Faith That Commands Results

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. The centurion's faith worked even at a distance.
 2. Jesus said, "I have not found anyone in Israel with such great faith."
 3. True faith doesn't need evidence; it trusts the Word.
 4. The centurion understood the power of authority.
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Lesson 4 – Joseph of Arimathea: Trust the Process

Activity – Connect the Process

Match each act of faith with the correct result:

- 1 Joseph's request for Jesus' body → **Jesus' body was placed in a tomb of honor.**
- 2 Building his own tomb → **God used a personal plan for divine purpose.**
- 3 Wrapping Jesus in linen → **The burial fulfilled prophecy with reverence.**
- 4 Rolling the stone → **A temporary seal that set up resurrection power.**